

THE ALL-AFFINE FUNCTIONAL GRAPH OF THE ZERO-TOTALIZED LYNNESS MAP OVER ODD FINITE FIELDS

ANONYMOUS

ABSTRACT. Let $\mathbb{F}_q$ be a finite field of odd order, set $\text{inv}_0(0) = 0$ and $\text{inv}_0(x) = x^{-1}$ for $x \neq 0$, and consider the all-affine self-map $\mathbf{L}(x, y) = (y, (1 + y) \text{inv}_0(x))$. We determine its complete functional graph. The plane splits disjointly into a generic Lyness locus, the two coordinate axes, and three exceptional tail layers. The recurrent set has $q^2 - 3q + 5$ points, while the tail polynomial is

$$(q^2 - 3q + 5) + (q - 1)z + (q - 2)z^2 + (q - 2)z^3;$$

thus the maximum tail is exactly three for every odd q . If r_q counts the roots of $a^2 - a - 1$, then the graph has $1 + r_q$ fixed points, two 2-cycles, $(q - 3)/2$ 4-cycles, and $((q - 2)(q - 3) - r_q)/5$ 5-cycles. We also prove a codomain-wide inverse law: fibres have size q at $(-1, 0)$, size zero at $(-1, v)$ for $v \neq 0$, and size one elsewhere. Classical Lyness five-periodicity, QRT and cluster interpretations, and general finite-field birational dynamics receive zero contribution credit. The residual result is the exact zero-totalized affine boundary completion. External release remains on hold.

1. SCOPE AND COMPLETE STATEMENT

The parameter-one Lyness recurrence and its five-cycle are classical. The same map is a basic QRT system and a type- A_2 cluster example [1, 2]. Integrable birational maps over finite fields also admit a general algebraic-geometric treatment [3]. All of that material is background here. We study one boundary convention on the whole affine plane, including every point at which the usual rational formula has a zero denominator.

Fix a finite field $\mathbb{F}_q$ of odd order. Define

$$(1) \quad \text{inv}_0(x) = \begin{cases} 0, & x = 0, \\ x^{-1}, & x \neq 0, \end{cases} \quad \mathbf{L}(x, y) = (y, (1 + y) \text{inv}_0(x)).$$

Let r_q be the number of roots in $\mathbb{F}_q$ of

$$(2) \quad a^2 - a - 1 = 0.$$

For a point P , its tail $\tau(P)$ is the least $t \geq 0$ such that $\mathbf{L}^t(P)$ is recurrent.

The five sets below will describe every point. Put

$$(3) \quad \mathcal{G} = \{(x, y) : xy(1 + x)(1 + y)(1 + x + y) \neq 0\},$$

$$(4) \quad \mathcal{A} = (\{0\} \times \mathbb{F}_q) \cup (\mathbb{F}_q \times \{0\}),$$

$$(5) \quad \mathcal{E}_1 = \{(a, -1) : a \in \mathbb{F}_q \setminus \{0\}\},$$

$$(6) \quad \mathcal{E}_2 = \{(-1 - a, a) : a \in \mathbb{F}_q \setminus \{0, -1\}\},$$

$$(7) \quad \mathcal{E}_3 = \{(-1, -1 - a) : a \in \mathbb{F}_q \setminus \{0, -1\}\}.$$

Theorem 1.1 (Complete all-affine atlas). *For every odd prime power q , the following statements hold.*

(i) *The five sets in (3)–(7) are pairwise disjoint and their union is $\mathbb{F}_q^2$. Their respective sizes are*

$$(8) \quad (q - 2)(q - 3), \quad 2q - 1, \quad q - 1, \quad q - 2, \quad q - 2.$$

The recurrent set is $\mathcal{G} \cup \mathcal{A}$, and τ equals j on $\mathcal{E}_j$. Consequently

$$(9) \quad \sum_{P \in \mathbb{F}_q^2} z^{\tau(P)} = (q^2 - 3q + 5) + (q - 1)z + (q - 2)z^2 + (q - 2)z^3.$$

In particular, the maximum tail is exactly three.

(ii) *The cycle census is*

2020 *Mathematics Subject Classification.* 37P05, 37P25, 11T06.

Key words and phrases. finite dynamics, finite field, Lyness map, functional graph, entry time, dynamical zeta function, fibre.

<i>cycle length</i>	<i>number of cycles</i>
1	$1 + r_q$
2	2
4	$(q - 3)/2$
5	$((q - 2)(q - 3) - r_q)/5$

There are no other cycles. Hence the dynamical zeta function is

$$(10) \quad \zeta_{\mathbb{L}}(z) = (1 - z)^{-(1+r_q)}(1 - z^2)^{-2}(1 - z^4)^{-(q-3)/2}(1 - z^5)^{-((q-2)(q-3)-r_q)/5}.$$

(iii) For every target $(u, v) \in \mathbb{F}_q^2$,

$$(11) \quad |\mathbb{L}^{-1}(u, v)| = \begin{cases} q, & (u, v) = (-1, 0), \\ 0, & u = -1 \text{ and } v \neq 0, \\ 1, & u \neq -1. \end{cases}$$

Thus $|\text{im } \mathbb{L}| = q^2 - q + 1$, and the exceptional in-tree attached to the two-cycle $(-1, 0) \leftrightarrow (0, -1)$ is exactly the one displayed in [corollary 4.2](#) below.

The next three sections prove [theorem 1.1](#). Enumeration is used only for the independent controls reported in [section 5](#).

2. DISJOINT STRATA AND THE SHARP TAIL POLYNOMIAL

We first prove coverage pointwise; the cardinality identity will be a consequence rather than a substitute.

Proposition 2.1 (Pointwise all-plane partition). *The sets $\mathcal{G}, \mathcal{A}, \mathcal{E}_1, \mathcal{E}_2, \mathcal{E}_3$ are pairwise disjoint and cover $\mathbb{F}_q^2$. Their sizes are given by [\(8\)](#).*

Proof. Every point of $\mathcal{A}$ has a zero coordinate. Every point in an exceptional set has two nonzero coordinates: the exclusions on the parameter in [\(5\)–\(7\)](#) guarantee this. Hence $\mathcal{A}$ is disjoint from the other four sets.

Now take $(x, y) \notin \mathcal{A}$. If $y = -1$, then $(x, y) \in \mathcal{E}_1$. Suppose $y \neq -1$. If $x = -1$, set $a = -1 - y$. Since $y \notin \{0, -1\}$, one has $a \notin \{0, -1\}$ and $(x, y) = (-1, -1 - a) \in \mathcal{E}_3$. Suppose also $x \neq -1$. If $1 + x + y = 0$, then $(x, y) = (-1 - a, a) \in \mathcal{E}_2$ with $a = y \notin \{0, -1\}$. If none of these three equalities holds, all five factors in [\(3\)](#) are nonzero, so $(x, y) \in \mathcal{G}$. The tests are ordered by mutually exclusive equations. They therefore prove both coverage and unique membership.

The axis union has size $2q - 1$, while the three exceptional parametrizations are injective and have sizes $q - 1, q - 2, q - 2$. Subtracting these disjoint sets from the q^2 points of the plane gives

$$|\mathcal{G}| = q^2 - (2q - 1) - (q - 1) - 2(q - 2) = (q - 2)(q - 3).$$

□

On $\mathcal{G}$, the zero-totalized map agrees for five steps with the classical rational recurrence. We record the algebra because it also verifies that no zero denominator is crossed.

Lemma 2.2 (Five iterates on the generic locus). *If $(x, y) \in \mathcal{G}$, then*

$$(12) \quad \begin{aligned} \mathbb{L}(x, y) &= \left(y, \frac{1+y}{x} \right), \\ \mathbb{L}^2(x, y) &= \left(\frac{1+y}{x}, \frac{1+x+y}{xy} \right), \\ \mathbb{L}^3(x, y) &= \left(\frac{1+x+y}{xy}, \frac{1+x}{y} \right), \\ \mathbb{L}^4(x, y) &= \left(\frac{1+x}{y}, x \right), \\ \mathbb{L}^5(x, y) &= (x, y). \end{aligned}$$

In particular every point of $\mathcal{G}$ is recurrent.

Proof. The five possible first coordinates at successive divisions are

$$x, \quad y, \quad \frac{1+y}{x}, \quad \frac{1+x+y}{xy}, \quad \frac{1+x}{y}.$$

They are all nonzero by [\(3\)](#), so inv_0 is ordinary inversion at every displayed step. Repeated substitution in [\(1\)](#) gives [\(12\)](#); the only cancellations use $(1+x)(1+y) = 1+x+y+xy$. The last line proves recurrence. □

The complement of $\mathcal{G}$ has equally explicit arrows.

Lemma 2.3 (Axes and exceptional layers). *For $a \in \mathbb{F}_q$,*

$$(13) \quad \mathbf{L}(0, a) = (a, 0), \quad \mathbf{L}(a, 0) = (0, a^{-1}) \quad (a \neq 0),$$

and $(0, 0)$ is fixed. For $a \in \mathbb{F}_q \setminus \{0, -1\}$,

$$(14) \quad (-1, -1 - a) \mapsto (-1 - a, a) \mapsto (a, -1) \mapsto (-1, 0),$$

while

$$(15) \quad (-1, -1) \mapsto (-1, 0) \mapsto (0, -1) \mapsto (-1, 0).$$

Proof. Equations (13) follow directly from $\text{inv}_0(0) = 0$ and $\text{inv}_0(a) = a^{-1}$ for $a \neq 0$. For the exceptional arrows, substitute into (1):

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{L}(-1, -1 - a) &= (-1 - a, a), \\ \mathbf{L}(-1 - a, a) &= \left(a, \frac{1 + a}{-1 - a}\right) = (a, -1), \\ \mathbf{L}(a, -1) &= (-1, 0). \end{aligned}$$

The parameter exclusions make each displayed denominator nonzero. The two remaining arrows in (15) are immediate. $\square$

Theorem 2.4 (Recurrent set and exact tails). *The recurrent set is $\mathcal{G} \cup \mathcal{A}$. The sets $\mathcal{E}_1, \mathcal{E}_2, \mathcal{E}_3$ are exactly the tail layers of depths 1, 2, 3, respectively. Hence (9) holds and the maximum tail is three.*

Proof. The generic points are recurrent by lemma 2.2. Equations (13) show that $(0, 0)$ is fixed and every other axis point lies in a cycle generated by inversion in $\mathbb{F}_q^*$. Thus every point of $\mathcal{A}$ is recurrent.

By lemma 2.3, $\mathcal{E}_1$ maps into the recurrent two-cycle in one step, $\mathcal{E}_2$ maps into $\mathcal{E}_1$, and $\mathcal{E}_3$ maps into $\mathcal{E}_2$. The disjointness in proposition 2.1 makes these depths exact. No exceptional point is recurrent because its orbit enters the invariant axis set and never returns to its exceptional stratum. This proves the recurrent-set assertion and all pointwise depths.

The recurrent coefficient is

$$|\mathcal{G}| + |\mathcal{A}| = (q - 2)(q - 3) + 2q - 1 = q^2 - 3q + 5.$$

Adding the three exceptional layer sizes gives (9). Since $q \geq 3$, the set $\mathcal{E}_3$ has size $q - 2 > 0$, so depth three is attained for every allowed field. $\square$

3. THE COMPLETE CYCLE CENSUS AND ZETA FUNCTION

The generic locus contributes only periods one and five. The axes contribute the remaining periods.

Lemma 3.1 (Fixed points). *The fixed points are $(0, 0)$ and the r_q points (a, a) satisfying (2). Every latter point belongs to $\mathcal{G}$.*

Proof. If $\mathbf{L}(x, y) = (x, y)$, then $y = x$. At $x = 0$ this gives $(0, 0)$. For $x \neq 0$, the second coordinate equation is $(1 + x)/x = x$, equivalently $x^2 - x - 1 = 0$. Conversely every such root gives a fixed point.

A root a is neither 0 nor -1 . It also satisfies $1 + 2a \neq 0$: otherwise $a = -1/2$, and substitution into $a^2 - a - 1$ gives $-1/4 \neq 0$ because the characteristic is odd. Thus all five factors defining $\mathcal{G}$ are nonzero at (a, a) . $\square$

Lemma 3.2 (Axis cycles). *The axes contain $(0, 0)$, exactly two 2-cycles, and exactly $(q - 3)/2$ 4-cycles. The 2-cycles are*

$$(16) \quad (0, 1) \longleftrightarrow (1, 0), \quad (0, -1) \longleftrightarrow (-1, 0).$$

For $a \in \mathbb{F}_q^ \setminus \{1, -1\}$, the inversion pair $\{a, a^{-1}\}$ indexes the 4-cycle*

$$(17) \quad (0, a) \mapsto (a, 0) \mapsto (0, a^{-1}) \mapsto (a^{-1}, 0) \mapsto (0, a).$$

Proof. The arrows are (13). An element of $\mathbb{F}_q^*$ is fixed by inversion exactly when $a^2 = 1$. Since the characteristic is odd, these are the two distinct elements 1 and -1 , and they give (16). Inversion acts without fixed points on the remaining $q - 3$ elements, giving $(q - 3)/2$ unordered pairs and the cycles (17). Distinct inversion pairs give disjoint cycles. $\square$

Theorem 3.3 (Cycle census). *The cycle counts in theorem 1.1(ii) are complete.*

Proof. The exceptional layers contain no recurrent point by [theorem 2.4](#). The axis contribution is completely classified by [lemma 3.2](#), including the fixed point $(0, 0)$. On $\mathcal{G}$, [lemma 2.2](#) shows that every least period divides the prime 5. By [lemma 3.1](#), exactly r_q generic points have period one; all other $(q - 2)(q - 3) - r_q$ generic points therefore have exact period five. Dividing by five gives their cycle count. These cases exhaust the disjoint partition from [proposition 2.1](#). $\square$

For a finite self-map, define

$$(18) \quad \zeta_L(z) = \exp \left(\sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{|\text{Fix}(L^n)|}{n} z^n \right).$$

Equivalently, a cycle of length d contributes $(1 - z^d)^{-1}$. Substituting the four counts from [theorem 3.3](#) gives (10). This last Euler product conversion is standard finite-map bookkeeping and receives zero contribution credit.

4. EVERY-TARGET FIBRES AND THE COMPLETE SINGULAR IN-TREE

The inverse problem is simpler than the forward stratification because a target's first coordinate fixes one source coordinate.

Theorem 4.1 (Every-target inverse law). *Equation (11) holds. Consequently $|\text{im } L| = q^2 - q + 1$, and $(-1, 0)$ is the unique target of maximum fibre.*

Proof. If $L(x, y) = (u, v)$, the first coordinate forces $y = u$, and the remaining equation is

$$(19) \quad (1 + u) \text{inv}_0(x) = v.$$

If $u = -1$, its left side is zero for every $x \in \mathbb{F}_q$. This gives all q sources $(x, -1)$ when $v = 0$ and no source when $v \neq 0$.

Suppose $u \neq -1$. If $v = 0$, then (19) forces $\text{inv}_0(x) = 0$, hence $x = 0$, giving the unique source $(0, u)$. If $v \neq 0$, the unique solution is the nonzero element $x = (1 + u)/v$. These cases prove (11).

There are $q(q - 1)$ targets with $u \neq -1$, all in the image, and the only image target with $u = -1$ is $(-1, 0)$. Thus the image size is $q(q - 1) + 1 = q^2 - q + 1$. Since $q \geq 3$, the fibre of size q is uniquely maximal. $\square$

Corollary 4.2 (Whole exceptional component). *The connected functional-graph component containing $(-1, 0) \leftrightarrow (0, -1)$ consists exactly of that two-cycle, the leaf*

$$(20) \quad (-1, -1) \mapsto (-1, 0),$$

and, for each $a \in \mathbb{F}_q \setminus \{0, -1\}$, the length-three chain

$$(21) \quad (-1, -1 - a) \mapsto (-1 - a, a) \mapsto (a, -1) \mapsto (-1, 0).$$

There are no further vertices or incoming branches in this component.

Proof. The displayed arrows are [lemma 2.3](#). It remains to prove completeness. The fibre of $(-1, 0)$ is exactly $\{(x, -1) : x \in \mathbb{F}_q\}$. Among these sources, $(0, -1)$ is the cycle predecessor, $(-1, -1)$ is (20), and the other $q - 2$ points are the endpoints $(a, -1)$ in (21).

For $a \notin \{0, -1\}$, the target $(a, -1)$ has the unique predecessor $(-1 - a, a)$, and that target has the unique predecessor $(-1, -1 - a)$, by the unique-source case of [theorem 4.1](#). Finally, $(-1, -1 - a)$ has first coordinate -1 and nonzero second coordinate, so its fibre is empty. The point $(-1, -1)$ has empty fibre for the same reason. The target $(0, -1)$ has the unique predecessor $(-1, 0)$. Thus no additional branch can enter any displayed vertex. $\square$

5. EXACT CONTROLS, LIMITATIONS, AND DECLARATIONS

The paper-local verifier constructs every literal state and target over all odd prime fields through 101 and six nonprime fields of orders 9, 25, 27, 49, 121, 125. It checks the field arithmetic, unique stratum membership, the five generic iterates, every pointwise tail and period, the cycle census, the temporal polynomial, every target fibre, and the complete exceptional predecessor sets. It uses exact standard-library arithmetic without sampling, floating point, a computer algebra system, runtime network access, or a third-party package.

control	exact count
finite-field boxes	31
state/target cells	110,095 each
nonprime field boxes	6
Boolean assertions	2,144,131

TABLE 1. Dependency-free falsification controls. These counts prove neither the all-parameter statements nor any ownership claim.

Limitations. The cycle census uses odd characteristic: in characteristic two the two elements 1 and -1 coincide, so the displayed pair of 2-cycles and the 4-cycle count do not persist. The note treats only the literal affine convention (1); it does not classify projective compactifications, other values assigned to inverse zero, general Lyness parameters, or higher-order recurrences. The exact controls cover finitely many fields and serve only as falsification. The source search was also bounded. A direct owner of the residual all-affine conjunction would reopen the result.

Data and code availability. No external dataset is used. The deterministic verifier and its frozen stdout transcript accompany the internal paper package. They are not an external release authorization.

Ethics statement. The work uses no human participants, animal subjects, personal data, or stochastic intervention, and raises no application-specific ethical issue.

Author contributions. The anonymous author or authors developed the finite system, proved the results, implemented the exact controls, audited the sources, and prepared the manuscript.

Conflict of interest. The anonymous author or authors declare no conflict of interest.

Funding. No external funding is declared for this anonymous internal manuscript.

Classical Lyness five-periodicity, QRT and cluster interpretations, finite-field birational methods, and generic zeta algebra remain zero-credit inputs. The residual is limited to the exact zero-totalized all-affine graph proved above. A bounded source non-hit is not novelty, priority, authorship, or ownership evidence. No posting, specialist contact, submission, or release is authorized; status remains `HOLD_EXTERNAL`.

REFERENCES

- [1] Andrew N. W. Hone. Efficient ECM factorization in parallel with the Lyness map. In *Proceedings of the 45th International Symposium on Symbolic and Algebraic Computation*, pages 234–240. ACM, 2020. doi: 10.1145/3373207.3404044.
- [2] Andrew N. W. Hone and Theodoros E. Kouloukas. Deformations of cluster mutations and invariant presymplectic forms. *Journal of Algebraic Combinatorics*, 57(3):763–791, 2023. doi: 10.1007/s10801-022-01203-5.
- [3] Danesh Jogia, John A. G. Roberts, and Franco Vivaldi. An algebraic geometric approach to integrable maps of the plane. *Journal of Physics A: Mathematical and General*, 39(5):1133–1149, 2006. doi: 10.1088/0305-4470/39/5/008.